



*Tarantulas are giant spiders that hunt on the ground or in trees, finding prey mainly by touch.*



*Small and sharp-eyed, jumping spiders hunt by day, leaping through the air onto their prey.*



*Mites include house dust mites, which are microscopic scavengers that feed on flakes of skin in household dust.*



*Ticks are bloodsucking parasites. This mating pair shows a small male on top of a female swollen with a meal of blood.*

## Sea spiders

Sea spiders are not closely related to spiders that live on land, even though they usually have eight legs. Their heads are tiny and their bodies extremely slender, with long legs that end in hooks. They are most common in shallow water, although some live on the deep seabed.



*Sea spiders clamber over seaweeds, rocks, and corals, feeding on animals and dead remains.*

## Springtails

Closely related to insects, springtails have six legs but no wings. If disturbed, they flick their tubular tails, which catapults them through the air. Most springtails are tiny. They are extremely common in leaf litter, on plants, and on the surface of pools and ponds.



*Some species of springtails feed on the surface of plants. Some cause serious damage to crops.*

## Centipedes

A centipede's body is made of many segments, each with a single pair of legs. Centipedes are carnivorous. Their flat bodies let them squeeze through crevices in search of prey.



*House centipedes' long, slender legs propel them at great speed. They are common indoors in many parts of the world.*



*A typical centipede has a poisonous claw, used to kill its prey, on each side of its head.*

## Millipedes

Unlike centipedes, millipedes have cylindrical bodies with two pairs of legs on each segment. The total number of legs varies from fewer than 50 to more than 700. They feed on the decaying remains of plants.

*A millipede's exoskeleton is reinforced with hard minerals, but it may also defend itself by coiling up and producing vile toxic chemicals.*

